PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, April 22, 2025

Special Meeting and Work Session

Meeting Minutes

(Adopted 5/6/25)

INDEX

Meeting Location and Attendance	02
Call to Order / Introductions	02
Consent Agenda: Resolutions 7094 through 7097	02
Measures of Academic Progress (MAP) Growth	02
Convened as the Budget Committee	02
Superintendent Proposes 2025-26 School Year Budget	02
Adjourned from the Budget Committee	02
Oregon Department of Education Integrated Grant Application 2025-27 for School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon (Resolution 7098)	03
Resolution to Add a Pay Grade to the Senior Leadership Salary Schedule (Resolution 7099)	03
Other Business	04
Written Update: Modernization Designs, Projected Cost Reductions, and Status Report on how the Designs Meet the Goals of Similar Features and Elements to Previous Modernizations and Education	04
Adjournment	04
Statement for the Record	05
Resolutions as adopted	07

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Special Meeting and Work Session of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Director Julia Brim-Edwards: Present; Director Michelle DePass: Present (arrived 8;08 pm); Director Herman Greene: Present; Director Gary Hollands: Present; Director Christy Splitt: Present; Director Patte Sullivan: Present; Director Edward Wang: Present; Student Representative Kunsevi: Present(virtual)

Call to Order / Introductions

The meeting was called to order by Board Chair 6:05 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Consent Agenda: Resolutions 7094 through 7097

Time: 6:06

No items were pulled from the consent agenda and there was no Board discussion.

Actions:

- Director Greene Moved and Director Hollands Seconded the motion to adopt the Consent Agenda, including Resolutions 7094 through 7097. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (Yes: 6, No: 0, Absent:1)

  Brim-Edwards: Yes; DePass: Absent; Greene: Yes; Hollands: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative JJ Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Measures of Academic Progress (MAP) Growth

Time: 6:08 pm

Staff: Dr. Renard Adams, Dr. Kristina Howard - chief academic officer, Dr. Isaac Cardona - Senior Director

Staff provided an overview of the Measures of Academic Progress (MAP) growth results, explaining how the data is used alongside OSAS to assess both student growth and progress toward grade-level expectations. Results showed that overall student growth has increased compared to the previous year, with more progress observed in math than reading. Staff described strategies being implemented in response to the data, including targeted student supports such as WIN blocks, high-impact tutoring, and academic interventions. Efforts have also been made to better align central office support with school-based instructional leadership. Board members asked questions regarding how growth is measured between testing points and how families are informed about student progress. Staff noted that parents receive written updates after assessments and that conferences provide additional opportunities for engagement.

Superintendent Proposes 2025-26 School Year Budget

Staff: Dr. Armstong, Dr. Renard Adams, Michelle Morrison, Deborah Kafoury

The Board Convened as the Budget Committee at 6:50 pm.

Chair Wang noted that the board would not receive public comment on the budget at this meeting, it marked the official kickoff of the budget process, and highlighted the adoption timeline, including opportunities for board discussion and public engagement. The superintendent shared her budget message, emphasizing alignment with district values, goals, and strategic plans, while also acknowledging the difficult reductions made due to financial pressures, including layoffs and a budget decrease compared to the previous year. Staff provided an overview of the budget development process, key planning strategies, and financial realities, including declining enrollment, rising costs, and limited revenue. It was noted that budget assumes the passage of the 2025 bond. Staff also reviewed staffing plans and noted future planning challenges related to changes in federal funding.

Board members raised questions and comments related to transparency in budget reductions, the impact of system changes, and the status of funding for Title 1 programs. They expressed interest in better understanding central office cuts, contract services, and program impacts such as athletics and arts. Also discussed were concerns about rising costs, unfunded mandates, and the need for stronger advocacy at the state level.

The Board adjourned from the Budget Committee at 8:02 pm.

Oregon Department of Education Integrated Grant Application 2025-27 for School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon (Resolution 7098)

Time 8:02 pm

Staff: Jey Buno – Chief of Student Support Services

It was noted that the Board received the presentation of the Oregon Department of Education Integrated Grant Application 2025-27 for School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon at the Regular Meeting held on April 08, 2025. An opportunity for public comment was provided at that meeting, however none was received. It was noted that the signed Tribal Consultation document was added before the meeting. In response to a question about the needs assessment recommendations, staff confirmed that all requirements have been met.

Actions:

- Director Brim-Edwards moved and Director Sullivan seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7098. This motion was put to a voice vote and passed (Yes: 6, No: 0, Absent: 1)

  Brim-Edwards: Yes, DePass: Absent, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Yes, Wang: Yes; Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Resolution to Add a Pay Grade to the Senior Leadership Salary Schedule (Resolution 7099)

Vote- Public comment accepted

Time: 8:06 pm

Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong - Superintendent

Dr. Armstrong presented a proposal to add a pay grade to the senior salary schedule as part of a broader central office reorganization, following FTE (full time employee) reductions. The reorganization includes consolidating roles, replacing aa contracted general counsel with a chief legal counsel for cost savings, and shifting more responsibility to fewer staff. The changes are intended to improve efficiency and responsiveness, particularly in schools.

Board members asked questions about which roles were cut, the cost and structure of the new cabinet, whether additional administrative support would be added, and the impact at the school level. There were concerns about implementing pay increases amid budget reductions and perceptions of adding layers back to leadership. While some supported the superintendent’s authority to structure her team, others expressed concern about timing and the optics of the change. Staff noted that overall, the reorganization is expected to result in cost savings.

Actions:

- Director Greene moved and Director Hollands seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7099. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed. (Yes: 6, No: 1)

  Brim-Edwards: No, DePass: Yes, Greene: Yes, Hollands: Yes, Splitt: Yes, Sullivan: Yes, Wang: Yes; Student Representative Kunsevi: Yes (unofficial)

Other Business

Time: 8:35 pm

Director Brim-Edwards stated she would submit comments for the record regarding the change in the modernization and then provided a statement regarding the change in the agenda item.

Adjourn

Adjourned at 8:38 pm

Written Update: Modernization Designs, Projected Cost Reductions, and Status Report on how the Designs Meet the Goals of Similar Features and Elements to Previous Modernizations and Education Specifications (Memo to the Board)

Written materials were provided on the topic.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools

Statement for the Record

From Director Julia Brim-Edwards

Statement from Julia Brim-Edwards for the Record for the April 22, 2025 Portland Public School Board of Education Meeting.

To keep the community informed about the May Bond as well as the Board-directed cost reductions and potential funds available for elementary and middle school improvements and repairs, the Portland School Board adopted an amendment to Resolution No. 7067 which required regular, public updates to the Board about the bond's cost reduction efforts and specified that there "be time available for questions and discussion" at the March 18, April 8 and the April 22* Board meetings.

At the April 8th Board meeting, the staff memo updating the board on the cost reductions included this statement about the cost reduction efforts and what funds would be available for elementary and middle school improvements and critical repairs: "The current combined estimated total project cost ranges from $1.348 billion to $1.380 billion. Of this, $406 million is funded through the 2020 General Obligation (GO) Bond. As a result, the remaining funding required for the projects is between $942 million and $974 million. The proposed 2025 GO Bond allocates $1.150 billion for modernization projects**, leaving a balance of $208 million to $176 million for additional modernization initiatives."** (staff put the text in bold). This was new and welcome information! From my perspective, it appeared that these additional funds could be added to the $190M for improvements and repairs already allocated in the bond for a total of about $400 Million. Given the 8-10 year timeframe for the bond, these added funds would enable the district to make many more improvements and repairs, including prioritizing seismic upgrades at elementary and middle schools at risk of collapse in an earthquake.

Following that meeting, on April 10 there was a scheduled meeting with the PPS Native Community and Superintendent where Native staff and families raised concerns and objected to the federally-funded Indian Education Program being erased from the revised design of the modernized Jefferson High School, its current home. Superintendent Armstrong suggested families and staff to come to the April 22nd Board meeting and raise their concerns with the Board.

In addition, families and parents of students in the unreinforced masonry schools at risk of collapse in an earthquake raised questions about the amount of funds and district plans to seismically retrofit for the 20+ schools built with unreinforced masonry given the additional funds that now appeared to be available in the April 8th meeting staff memo. During the bond planning last November, a staff memo indicated in a sample spending plan that there would only be approximately $5-10M available to retrofit 1-2 schools from the $190M allocation for repairs and improvements, a fraction of the schools needing seismic upgrades that would be in danger of collapsing during a significant earthquake. This is not a meaningful or enforceable commitment.

With new information about funds from the cost savings and questions about seismic prioritization, as well as the superintendent telling Indian Education families to come to the April 22nd Board meeting, the Resolution designating time for discussion and questions at the April 22nd Board meeting seemed the natural time to have a public discussion about those issues given the Board can only conduct its work or have discussions in public meetings.

The meeting agenda that was shared with the Board had an update on the May 2025 Bond as a discussion item. The day before the meeting, the Board received a notice that the Board was going to get a written report, which was fine given the Board-approved resolution still had the requirement that there be an opportunity for "discussion and questions" at the meeting.

It was disappointing then that the Chair moved to close the meeting and to bypass the Board resolution requirements. Board resolutions should be followed, agenda items shouldn't be unilaterally pulled, and public discussions should not be shut down. For that reason, I indicated that I would be submitting this statement for the record about the process and the issues that had been raised relating to the bond. School communities with modernizations, families with students in seismically unsafe schools and the Indian Parent Community were expecting the April 22nd meeting to be the place to understand and share information as it was the public meeting the Board and Superintendent had indicated would be the forum.

Public trust and credibility require conversations to happen at public meetings, and our community has the right to ask and understand what is in the bond package and how projects are going to be prioritized.

The Board and staff should not backburner concerns that have been raised, rather it should discuss, answer questions, and potentially take action on issues relating to the bond in its public meetings. The bond was referred in January, and we've already taken action twice since then to direct staff to make cost reductions in the three high school modernizations and to report back to the Board in public Board meetings.

The Board, acting in a public meeting can clarify, provide direction, and state its intentions and commitments so that the community is aware of what it is voting on with some degree of specificity. A statement or interpretation about the Bond by an individual board member, the Superintendent, or a staff member in private or to which the Board majority has not agreed has no authority; the majority of a Board acting in a public meeting is the mechanism by which the Board can make clear its intentions.

Given the missed opportunity on April 22nd, we should convene a Special Meeting or establish a May 6 meeting agenda item to provide further direction to the Superintendent to memorialize a commitment to prioritizing seismic upgrades in the bond, allocating funds for the purpose, and sharing a transparent process for the planning and prioritization of seismic upgrades. The Native community also deserves a commitment that they will be part of the process of identifying the new home for Indian Education.

*Originally the Resolution specified the April 15th meeting, but given there was not an April 15 meeting the Resolution was amended at the next board meeting with the April 22nd meeting date.

Resolutions As Adopted

No.	Title	Page
7094	Adoption of the Minutes	08
7095	Authorization for Off-Campus Activities	09
7096	Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority	10
7097	Revenue Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority	12
7098	Oregon Department of Education Integrated Grant Application 2025-27 for School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon	13
7099	Resolution to Add a Pay Grade to the Senior Leadership Salary Schedule	14

RESOLUTION No. 7094

Adoption of the Minutes

The Following Minutes are offered for Adoption:

- April 08, 2025 – Regular Meeting

RESOLUTION No. 7095

Authorization for Off-Campus Activities

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Policy 6.50.010-P ("Off-Campus Activities") requires the Board of Education ("Board") consent to student out-of-state travel.

RESOLUTION

The Board has reviewed the request for out-of-state travel. All required documents have been submitted to the Risk Management Department. The Superintendent recommends that the Board consent to the student out-of-state travel for the below request:

AUTHORIZATION FOR OFF-CAMPUS ACTIVITIES

Date(s)	School, Course, & Number of Students	Purpose of Travel	Travel Destination	Estimated Cost	Equitable Field Trip Fund; %
4/10-4/13/25	Roosevelt HS Track, 2	Arcadia Invitational Meet	Arcadia High School, CA	$894	100%
4/11-4/13/25	McDaniel HS Performing Arts, 34	Perform in national music festival	San Francisco, CA	$790	$
4/11-4/14/25	Lincoln HS Ethics, 5	National HS Ethics Bowl	University of NC	$1700	N/A
4/15-4/20/25	Grant HS Robotics, 35	STEM/Robotics Competition	Houston, TX	$1711	N/A
4/20-4/27/25	RHS CHS MHS Indigenous Alliance, 17	Increase post secondary exposure among historically underserved populations	New Mexico & Colorado	$2608	$70,000
4/24-4/26/25	Roosevelt HS Mass Comms, 27	National HS Journalism Conference	Seattle, WA	$581	100%
4/24-4/26/25	Cleveland HS Journalism, 14	National HS Journalism Conference	Seattle, WA	$350	N/A
4/25-4/30/25	Wells HS DECA, 16	International Career Development Conference	Orlando, FL	$2500	N/A
6/21-6/28/25	Roosevelt HS Theater, 25	International Thespian Festival	University of Indiana	$2260	$2200 STEF

RESOLUTION No. 7096

Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts and approve payment for products, materials, supplies, capital outlay, equipment, and services whenever the total amount exceeds $150,000 per contract, excepting settlement or real property agreements. Contracts meeting this criterion are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the Deputy Clerk to enter into the following agreements.

NEW CONTRACTS

Contractor	Contract Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Contract Amount	Responsible Admin, Funding Source	Certified Business
Ednetics, Inc.	4/23/25 through 4/23/26	Construction C 96393	2020 Bond Security Cameras & Intrusion Systems at 16 schools. Invitation to Bid – Construction 2025-003	$1,307,348	D. Jung Fund 459 Dept. 5511 Project DS019	No

*A Certified Business is a for-profit business certified as a Minority-Owned Businesses (MBE), Women-Owned Businesses (WBE), Emerging Small Businesses (ESB), and/or Service-Disabled Veteran Businesses (SDV) by the State of Oregon Certification Office for Business Inclusion and Diversity.

NEW COOPERATIVE PURCHASING AGREEMENTS

Contractor	Contract Term, Renewal Options	Administering Contracting Agency	Description of Goods or Services	Estimated Spend During Contract Term	Responsible Administrator, Funding Source
WW Grainger, Inc.	4/23/25 through 8/31/26 Option to renew for up to two additional two-year terms through 8/31/30	State of Oregon COA 96146	Purchase of Maintenance, Repair & Operations (MRO) supplies for as-needed District-wide use.	$500,000	M. Morrison Funding Source Varies

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

Contractor	Amendment Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Amendment Amount; New Contract Amount	Responsible Administrator, Funding Source	Certified Business

Florida Virtual School	7/1/25 through 6/30/27	Digital Resource DR 93563 Amendment 5	Digital curriculum for online schooling. This amendment extends the contract and adds funds for two additional years. Special Class Procurement – Software and Hardware Upgrades and/or Maintenance PPS-47-0288(11)	$84,000 $169,500	J. Buno Funding Source Varies	NA - Nonprofit
Teachers Curriculum Institute, Inc.	4/23/25 through 6/30/26	Digital Resource DR 93412 Amendment 2	2020 Bond – Curriculum for TCI Social Sciences, grades 6-12. This amendment extends the contract and adds funds for one additional year. Special Class Procurement – Copyrighted Materials & Creative Works PPS-47-0288(4)	$579,200 $1,418,780	K. Howard Funding Source Varies	No
Woodruff Business & Technology Law LLC	4/23/25 through 6/30/26	Legal Services LS 90059 Amendment 3	Ongoing legal services. This amendment extends the end date and adds funds for one additional year. Direct Negotiation – Legal Services PPS-46-0525(13)	$50,000 $190,000	L. Large Fund 101 Dept. 5460	No

RESOLUTION No. 7097

Revenue Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts, except as otherwise expressly authorized. Contracts exceeding $150,000 per contractor are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the Deputy Clerk to enter into the following agreements.

NEW REVENUE CONTRACTS

Contractor	Contract Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Contract Amount	Responsible Admin, Funding Source
Portland General Electric	2/28/25 through 9/30/26	Revenue R 96398	Grant funding for purchase of at least two electric buses.	$371,823	D. Jung

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

No New Intergovernmental Agreements

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

No New Amendments to Existing Revenue Contracts

RESOLUTION NO. 7098

Oregon Department of Education Integrated Grant Application 2025-27 for School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon

RECITALS

A. Through *Integrated Guidance for Student Success*, the Oregon Department of Education has integrated nine initiatives. Six targeted programs include: High School Success, Student Investment Account, Early Indicator and Intervention Systems, Early Literacy Success, Career and Technical Education, and Federal School Improvement for Targeted/Comprehensive Supports. There are three embedded programs: Continuous Improvement Planning, Career Connected Learning, and Every Day Matters. Embedded programs are unfunded with requirements integrated in other initiatives.
B. For PPS, these initiatives programs have common goals and elements that are strongly aligned with district strategies.
C. Through a comprehensive and collaborative process, PPS has developed a plan that directly aligns to the stated purposes for the Integrated Grant funds.
D. For 2025-26, Integrated Grant funds collectively represent $63 million in state and federal funding for PPS; this is based on the preliminary allocation and includes charter school and community-based organization allocations.

Program	PPS Preliminary Allocation	
	2025-26	2026-27
High School Success (HSS)	$13,162,644	$13,699,894
Student Investment Account (SIA)	$45,163,269	$47,006,668
Early Literacy Success	$3,131,583	$3,259,403
Career Technical Education - Perkins V (CTE)	$470,328	$470,328
Federal School Improvement (FSI/CSI/TSI)	$938,838	TBD
Early Indicators & Intervention Systems (EIIS)	$125,172	$125,172
Total Allocation	**$62,991,834**	**$64.6 million (estimate)**

E. The PPS Integrated Grant budget plan allocates pass-through Student Investment Account funds to charter schools and community-based organizations (CBOs). This plan allocates $2.2 million to charter schools and CBOs for 2025-26. The allocation includes:
    - Funding based on a weighted Average Daily Membership (ADMw) to ensure the schools and organizations receive the SIA funds our district was allocated for our shared students.
    - An additional equity allocation based on the district's equity formula. The equity funding is designed to bolster support for historically underserved students.
F. The district will provide targeted, periodic updates specific to this plan as required by the Oregon Department of Education's Integrated Grant Guidance.
G. The Oregon Department of Education requires Board approval of the Integrated Grant Application.

RESOLUTION

1. BE IT RESOLVED that the Board of Directors approve the 2025-27 Integrated Grant Application that will be submitted to the Oregon Department of Education.

RESOLUTION No. 7099

Resolution to Add a Pay Grade to the Senior Leadership Salary Schedule

RECITALS

The District's current senior leadership salary schedule does not have a SL250 pay grade, and the Superintendent recommends adding a range SL250 of $224,000 to $239,000.

RESOLUTION

The PPS Board of Education approves adding an SL250 pay grade to the Senior Leadership Salary Schedule at a range of $224,000 to $239,000.